



special

shows what makes OT

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Motivation

Why look at other divergences?

- **Contextualization:** OT is one member of a much larger family of ways to compare distributions.
- **Insight:** Contrasting with KL, MMD, Energy, etc. **shows what makes OT special** (geometry, transport).
- **Practice:** In applications, the choice of divergence matters — OT is powerful, but **sometimes others are more appropriate** (eg efficient).
- **Takeaway:** Understanding the landscape helps you know when OT is the right tool — and when it isn't.

Three Ways to Compare

